

All figures sourced from Government of Alberta open data, Statistics Canada, federal statute, UN treaty, and peer-reviewed research.

Building Up: A Blueprint for the Alberta Accessibility and Inclusion Act

Part One — The Architecture Alberta Built and the Lifecycle Failures It Produced

Section 1.9 — The Disability-Poverty Intersection

Section 1.7 documented mental health disability and addiction as a substantive lifecycle dimension. Section 1.8 documented rural, remote, and northern Alberta as a substantive lifecycle dimension. Section 1.9 documents the substantive disability-and-poverty intersection that operates as the structural backbone of the categorical-program architecture and that compounds with every other lifecycle dimension Part One has documented. The section establishes that poverty is not an incidental outcome of the Alberta disability-policy architecture; poverty is engineered into the benefit-level design of the categorical-program architecture and is sustained over time through specific provincial-government policy choices that the documented record makes operationally visible.

The substantive claim is dispositive. The AISH benefit-level for a single Albertan with a disability operates at approximately eighty percent of the Market Basket Measure (MBM) Poverty Line in 2024; the Maytree welfare-incomes time series establishes that the AISH benefit has operated below the Poverty Line in eighteen of the nineteen years from 2006 to 2024; the *Persons with Developmental Disabilities Foundation Act*-administered PDD program, the Family Support for Children with Disabilities (FSCD) program, and the Income Support program's Barriers to Full Employment (BFE) provision all operate at substantively more inadequate levels relative to the Poverty Line; the ADAP transition documented in Section 1.4 will reduce the monthly benefit by two hundred dollars (from one thousand nine hundred forty dollars to one thousand seven hundred forty dollars) effective July 1, 2026, with a transition top-up to December 31, 2027 and structural eligibility narrowing thereafter; the federal Canada Disability Benefit (CDB) introduced in 2025 with a maximum of two hundred dollars per month is operationally clawed back dollar-for-dollar by the Alberta provincial government, making Alberta the only province in Canada that operates a CDB clawback policy; the substantive provincial-government policy direction documented in the November 2018 Bill 26 indexation, the 2019 UCP de-indexation, and the 2023 Alberta Escalator framework establishes a sustained structural-policy pattern that produces continuing erosion of the substantive benefit-level relative to the Poverty Line.

The compounding effects of the engineered structural poverty operate across every lifecycle dimension Part One has documented. Persons with disabilities in poverty face structural barriers to food security, structural barriers to housing security, structural barriers to accessing accommodations not covered by the categorical-program architecture, structural barriers to disability-community advocacy capacity, structural barriers to legal and procedural representation in disability-policy processes, structural barriers to accessing the substantive consultation infrastructure that the international human rights framework requires, and structural barriers to the substantive social-and-political participation that the substantive equality principle establishes as the foundation of the international human rights framework. The structural barriers operate cumulatively rather than discretely; the operational outcome is that persons with disabilities in poverty are systematically excluded from the substantive participation the disability-policy

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architecture is rhetorically designed to support.

The section develops the substantive content in seven components. The first establishes the substantive arithmetic of the engineered poverty: the specific dollar-amounts, the specific Poverty Line measurements, the specific gaps. The second documents the substantive nineteen-year time series that establishes the structural pattern. The third documents the substantive policy-choice sequence (Bill 26 indexation, UCP de-indexation, Alberta Escalator, ADAP, CDB clawback) through which the structural pattern has been sustained. The fourth documents the compounding effects of disability-and-poverty intersection. The fifth addresses the substantive intersection with each lifecycle dimension Part One has documented. The sixth documents the substantive operational consequences for the substantive disability-community-engagement capacity that the substantive consultation framework requires. The seventh synthesizes what the section establishes for the substantive case the blueprint develops.

The substantive content of Section 1.9 is grounded in primary-source documentation: the Maytree *Welfare in Canada: Alberta* time-series data, the Statistics Canada Market Basket Measure provisional and final poverty estimates, the Disability Action Hall analytical work, the Enough for All Calgary policy analysis, and the disability-community advocacy documentation that has consistently identified the substantive disability-and-poverty intersection as the structural backbone of the Alberta categorical-program architecture.

The Substantive Arithmetic of the Engineered Poverty

The substantive arithmetic of the engineered poverty is operationally specific. The Statistics Canada Market Basket Measure operates as Canada's Official Poverty Line, established in 2018 following the release of *Opportunity for All — Canada's First Poverty Reduction Strategy*. The MBM thresholds are based on the cost of a basket of goods and services that reflects a "modest, basic standard of living" and are calibrated to specific geographic regions including Edmonton and Calgary. Source: <https://www150.statcan.gc.ca/n1/pub/75f0002m/75f0002m2025008-eng.htm>. The 2024 MBM Poverty Line for Calgary is approximately twenty-eight thousand nine hundred fifty-four dollars annually for a single individual; the Edmonton threshold operates at a slightly lower level. Source: <https://ca.news.yahoo.com/opinion-aish-reform-deja-vu-120026146.html>.

The substantive AISH benefit-level for a single Albertan with a disability is one thousand nine hundred forty dollars per month (twenty-three thousand two hundred eighty dollars annually) as of January 1, 2024, following the 4.25 percent indexation increase under the Alberta Escalator framework. Source: <https://maytree.com/changing-systems/data-measuring/welfare-in-canada/alberta/>. The substantive arithmetic produces an annual gap of five thousand six hundred seventy-four dollars between the AISH benefit-level and the 2024 Calgary MBM Poverty Line (\$28,954 - \$23,280). The substantive operational implication is that the AISH benefit-level operates approximately eighty percent of the Poverty Line; the Maytree welfare-incomes time series documents the precise figure as eighty percent in 2024.

The substantive arithmetic for the other categorical-program-eligible populations operates at substantively more inadequate levels. The unattached single with a disability receiving Income Support program Barriers to Full Employment (BFE) benefits in 2024 operates at fifty-seven percent of the Market Basket

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Measure Deep Income Poverty (MBM-DIP) threshold and forty-three percent of the MBM. Source: *Maytree Welfare in Canada: Alberta*. The substantive operational gap is nine thousand five hundred eighty-seven dollars below the Deep Income Poverty threshold and seventeen thousand twenty-one dollars below the Poverty Line. The unattached single considered employable receiving Income Support benefits (without disability designation) operates at fifty percent of the MBM-DIP and thirty-seven percent of the MBM, producing a gap of eleven thousand two hundred thirteen dollars below the Deep Income Poverty threshold and eighteen thousand six hundred forty-seven dollars below the Poverty Line. The Maytree analysis establishes that "households in these circumstances would have experienced a deepening of their already very deep poverty over the past 23 years."

The substantive ADAP transition documented in Section 1.4 will reduce the monthly benefit from one thousand nine hundred forty dollars to one thousand seven hundred forty dollars effective July 1, 2026 — a two-hundred-dollar monthly reduction (twenty-four-hundred dollars annually). The transition includes a temporary top-up provision maintaining current payment levels until December 31, 2027, after which the substantive structural reduction will operate. Source: <https://immigrationnewscanada.ca/new-aish-payments-for-alberta-march-2026/>. The substantive operational implication for the ADAP recipient population is that the substantive benefit-level will operate substantively below the AISH benefit-level documented in the prior arithmetic, producing a substantive Poverty Line gap of approximately seven thousand seven hundred dollars (the AISH gap of five thousand six hundred seventy-four dollars plus the additional two-thousand-four-hundred-dollar annual reduction, before any further inflation-related deterioration).

The substantive arithmetic establishes that the disability-and-poverty intersection in Alberta is not produced by external economic conditions or by individual circumstances; the substantive arithmetic is produced by specific provincial-government policy choices that establish benefit-levels operating below the Poverty Line by specific dollar-amounts that the documented data make operationally visible.

The Substantive Nineteen-Year Time Series

The substantive nineteen-year time series of AISH benefit-levels relative to the Market Basket Measure Poverty Line establishes the structural pattern through which the engineered poverty has been sustained across multiple political-administration changes. The Maytree welfare-incomes time series documents the substantive trajectory as follows.

In 2006, the AISH benefit-level for a single recipient operated at eighty-one percent of the Poverty Line. The substantive trajectory rose through the subsequent years, reaching one hundred and one percent of the Poverty Line in 2013 — the only year in the nineteen-year time series during which the AISH benefit-level operationally met or exceeded the Poverty Line threshold. The substantive trajectory then declined: eighty-two percent in 2018 (following the 2018 MBM rebasing), seventy-six percent in 2022 (the lowest point in the nineteen-year time series since 2006), eighty-one percent in 2023 (following the 2018 NDP Bill 26 indexation provisions and subsequent benefit-level adjustments), and eighty percent in 2024 (the most recent year in the time series). Source: *Maytree Welfare in Canada: Alberta*, <https://maytree.com/changing-systems/data-measuring/welfare-in-canada/alberta/>.

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The substantive operational finding is that "households in these circumstances would have effectively seen no improvement to their poverty level across the 19-year time series, despite the improvement between 2012 and 2017." The substantive operational reality is that the AISH-recipient population in 2024 operates at substantively the same poverty level relative to the Poverty Line as the AISH-recipient population in 2006 — the brief improvement period between 2012 and 2017 was reversed by subsequent policy choices, and the substantive long-term trajectory is one of structural-policy continuity rather than progress.

The substantive time-series finding for the BFE-eligible disability population (the population receiving Income Support disability supplements but not meeting the AISH-eligibility criteria) is operationally more stark. The BFE benefit-level relative to the Poverty Line declined from fifty-four percent in 2006 to forty-three percent in 2024, a nine-percentage-point decline across the nineteen-year time series. The substantive operational reality is that BFE-recipient households face a sustained deepening of their already-deep poverty over the documented period, with the substantive operational consequences operating across the lifecycle dimensions Part One has documented.

The substantive time-series finding establishes that the engineered structural-poverty pattern in Alberta is not an incidental policy outcome subject to occasional revision based on political-administration changes; it is a sustained structural-policy pattern that has operated across multiple political-administration changes and that has been sustained through specific policy-choice sequences the next subsection documents.

The Substantive Policy-Choice Sequence

The substantive policy-choice sequence through which the engineered structural-poverty pattern has been sustained operates across four specific provincial-government decisions in the recent period.

The 2018 NDP Bill 26 indexation. In November 2018, the Alberta New Democratic provincial government passed Bill 26 (*An Act to Combat Poverty and Fight for Albertans with Disabilities*), which implemented modest increases to the AISH and Income Support benefit-levels, expanded eligibility for some categorical programs, and indexed benefits to inflation. The substantive operational implication of indexation was that benefit-levels would maintain real-dollar value over time even as inflation eroded the substantive purchasing power of the benefits. Source: <https://enoughforall.ca/articles/a-closer-look-at-albertas-new-indexation-framework>. The substantive policy choice operationalized the substantive principle that disability-related categorical-program benefits should not erode in real-dollar terms over time.

The 2019 UCP de-indexation. In 2019, less than a year after the Bill 26 indexation took effect, the newly-elected United Conservative provincial government de-indexed AISH and Income Support benefits, reversing the indexation provisions established in Bill 26. The substantive operational consequence was that benefit-levels began to erode in real-dollar terms relative to inflation. The substantive operational impact was substantively compounded by the 2020-2022 inflation surge that produced cumulative real-dollar reductions of substantial magnitude. The Maytree time-series data documents the substantive consequence: the 2022 AISH-to-Poverty Line ratio (seventy-six percent) was the lowest point in the nineteen-year time series since 2006, reflecting the cumulative effect of de-indexation operating through

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the inflation surge.

The 2023 Alberta Escalator framework. Following sustained criticism of the de-indexation policy, the provincial government introduced Bill 32 in 2023, establishing the "Alberta Escalator" framework. The Alberta Escalator increases income supports by the minimum of (a) the change in the Alberta Consumer Price Index, or (b) two percent. The substantive operational implication is that benefit-levels are partially indexed but with a structural-cap that produces real-dollar erosion when inflation exceeds two percent. The Enough for All policy analysis documents the substantive operational impact: when Alberta inflation operates above two percent (as it did in 2023 and 2024), the Alberta Escalator produces benefit-level increases below the inflation rate, generating a structural gap between fully-indexed benefits and Alberta-Escalator-indexed benefits that operates "in perpetuity" because the gap is locked in each time inflation exceeds the two-percent cap. The substantive policy choice operationalizes the substantive principle that disability-related categorical-program benefits will be permitted to erode in real-dollar terms during periods of higher-than-two-percent inflation, while maintaining nominal-dollar increases that produce political-presentation benefits without producing real-dollar protection.

The 2026 ADAP transition. The substantive ADAP transition documented in Section 1.4 will reduce the monthly benefit from one thousand nine hundred forty dollars to one thousand seven hundred forty dollars effective July 1, 2026. The substantive operational implication is that the structural-poverty arithmetic will deepen by an additional two-thousand-four-hundred dollars annually for ADAP-eligible recipients, with the substantive Poverty Line gap reaching approximately seven thousand seven hundred dollars annually (before further inflation-related erosion).

The 2024 federal Canada Disability Benefit and the Alberta clawback. The federal Canada Disability Benefit (CDB) introduced in 2025 under the *Canada Disability Benefit Act* (S.C. 2023, c. 9) operates as a federal income-support benefit for working-age persons with disabilities, with a maximum of two hundred dollars per month. The substantive federal policy intent is to address the disproportionate poverty experienced by Canadians with disabilities by providing supplementary federal income-support that operates above the provincial categorical-program architecture. The Alberta provincial-government policy choice has been to claw back the CDB dollar-for-dollar from AISH recipients, reducing the AISH benefit-level by two hundred dollars per month for AISH recipients who are approved for the federal CDB. Source: <https://www.canadadisabilitybenefit.ca/cdb-and-aish>. The substantive operational consequence is that AISH recipients receive zero net financial benefit from the federal CDB; the federal benefit is operationally diverted from the AISH-recipient population to the provincial-government revenue. The substantive analytical finding is that **Alberta is the only province in Canada that has implemented a CDB clawback policy**. The substantive policy choice operationalizes the substantive principle that supplementary federal income-support to persons with disabilities will be operationalized as substitution for, rather than supplement to, provincial-government disability income-support, with the substantive operational consequence that the federal-government disability-poverty-reduction policy intent is operationally defeated within the Alberta context.

The four-decision policy-choice sequence operates as a sustained structural-policy pattern. Each individual decision can be characterized as a discrete policy choice with its own substantive operational rationale; the cumulative pattern across the four decisions establishes a structural-policy direction that produces sustained engineered-poverty for the disability population.

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The Compounding Effects of the Disability-and-Poverty Intersection

The substantive disability-and-poverty intersection produces compounding effects that operate across the lifecycle dimensions Part One has documented. The compounding effects are not abstract; they operate at the substantive operational level for the populations the disability-policy architecture is intended to serve.

Food insecurity. The substantive AISH benefit-level operating below the Poverty Line produces structural food-insecurity for AISH-recipient households. The Disability Action Hall analytical work documents that food bank use strongly predicts future homelessness, establishing the substantive operational sequence through which the structural food-insecurity produced by inadequate benefit-levels operates as a leading indicator of subsequent housing-insecurity outcomes. Source: <https://www.actionhall.ca/2025/09/adap-vs-aish-smarter-more-efficient-path.html>. The substantive disability-and-poverty intersection thus operates not only at the immediate-food-security level but at the broader life-stability level.

Housing insecurity. The substantive AISH benefit-level operates below the documented Calgary "modest standard of living" cost of approximately three thousand two hundred ninety-four dollars per month (May 2024 figure for a typical single individual including housing, food, transportation, clothing, and modest discretionary expenditure), producing a one-thousand-three-hundred-fifty-four-dollar monthly gap that AISH recipients must close through some combination of substandard housing, food deprivation, foregoing other essential expenditures, or accepting financial precarity that produces sustained operational stress. Source: <https://www.actionhall.ca/2025/09/adap-vs-aish-smarter-more-efficient-path.html>. The substantive operational reality is that twenty-nine percent of AISH recipients live in Calgary (the highest-cost region of Alberta), where the substantive cost-of-living gap operates most acutely. The substantive housing-insecurity outcomes include substandard housing conditions that produce additional disability-related operational complications, housing-instability and unplanned moves that disrupt the substantive social-supports and community-connections that disability-related quality-of-life depends on, and structural homelessness for AISH-eligible Albertans whose substantive housing arrangements collapse under the cost pressure.

Inability to afford accommodations not covered by the categorical-program architecture. The substantive categorical-program architecture covers some disability-related expenses through the AISH health benefits framework (prescription medications, some dental services, optical services, some Alberta Aids to Daily Living program coverage, some essential diabetic supplies). The substantive operational reality is that the categorical-program coverage operates with substantive gaps including specific medications not covered, accessibility-related home modifications that exceed the AADL coverage limits, transportation costs for medical appointments operating beyond the categorical-program transportation coverage, accommodations and aids that are operationally necessary but not categorical-program-covered, and uncovered out-of-pocket healthcare expenditures (psychotherapy, specialist consultations operating outside the public Health Care Insurance Plan, some specialist diagnostic services, supplementary disability-related services). Persons with disabilities operating below

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the Poverty Line lack the substantive financial capacity to cover these uncovered expenditures, with substantive operational consequences for their substantive quality-of-life and substantive disability-management.

Constraint on disability-community advocacy capacity. The substantive disability-and-poverty intersection produces structural constraint on the disability-community advocacy capacity that the substantive consultation framework Section 3.6 develops requires. Persons with disabilities operating below the Poverty Line lack the substantive financial capacity to engage in the substantive operational labour that disability-community advocacy requires (transportation to advocacy events, time commitment that operates against substantive employment-and-income-pursuit obligations, technology and communications infrastructure required for substantive advocacy participation, the substantive financial costs of disability-community-organization membership and engagement, and the substantive financial capacity to support disability-community advocacy organizations through donations and operational support). The substantive operational consequence is that the substantive disability-community advocacy capacity is structurally constrained relative to the substantive scope the substantive consultation framework requires; the engineered structural-poverty thus operates not only on the individual-quality-of-life level but on the substantive collective-political-engagement level.

Constraint on legal and procedural representation. The substantive disability-and-poverty intersection produces structural constraint on the legal and procedural representation capacity that the substantive categorical-program architecture's appeal-rights provisions require. Persons with disabilities operating below the Poverty Line lack the substantive financial capacity to access legal counsel for AISH/PDD/FSCD/WCB appeals, for the substantive *Compassionate Intervention Act* appeals (developed in Section 1.7), for the substantive *Mental Health Act* review-board engagements, and for the substantive disability-related civil and administrative proceedings that operate within the legal and procedural framework. The Legal Aid Alberta program operates with substantive eligibility-criteria and substantive operational capacity-constraints that produce coverage gaps for substantial portions of the disability-and-poverty population. The substantive operational consequence is that the substantive appeal-rights and procedural-protections established in the categorical-program architecture and the broader legal framework operate at substantively reduced effectiveness for persons with disabilities operating below the Poverty Line, with substantive operational implications for the substantive case the blueprint develops.

Constraint on substantive social and political participation. The substantive disability-and-poverty intersection produces structural constraint on the substantive social and political participation that the substantive equality principle establishes as the foundation of the international human rights framework. The substantive participation requires substantive financial capacity to operate within the social and political infrastructure (transportation, communications, time, materials, accommodations); persons with disabilities operating below the Poverty Line lack this substantive financial capacity; the substantive operational consequence is that the substantive equality of participation is structurally constrained at the substantive financial level even where it is rhetorically established at the policy level.

The compounding effects operate cumulatively rather than discretely. The substantive operational outcome is that persons with disabilities in poverty experience structural exclusion from the substantive participation that the disability-policy architecture is rhetorically designed to support, and the substantive

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engineered-structural-poverty operates as the substantive operational mechanism through which the structural exclusion is sustained.

Intersection with the Lifecycle Dimensions

The substantive disability-and-poverty intersection compounds with each lifecycle dimension Part One has documented:

FSCD (Section 1.3). Families with children with disabilities operating below the Poverty Line face substantive operational complications including: substantive cost barriers to accessing FSCD-eligible services that operate within the program-coverage gaps documented in Section 1.3; substantive cost barriers to accessing private specialist services that operate outside the FSCD coverage; substantive operational complications for the substantive caregiver-employment trajectory that the categorical-program architecture imposes through structural-employment-income limitations; substantive housing-insecurity that compounds with the substantive accessibility-modification needs that families with children with disabilities require; and substantive food-insecurity that compounds with the specific dietary-and-nutritional needs that some children with disabilities require for substantive operational management of their conditions.

K-12 (Sections 1.3 and 1.3a). Families with children with disabilities operating in the K-12 system below the Poverty Line face substantive operational complications including: substantive cost barriers to accessing private specialist services that operate alongside the public-school-based services to address the substantive specialist-services availability gaps documented in Section 1.3a; substantive cost barriers to accessing the legal and procedural representation that the substantive accommodation-dispute resolution and placement-decision-appeal frameworks require; substantive operational complications for the substantive parent-and-family advocacy participation that the substantive consultation framework requires; substantive transportation barriers that compound with the substantive school-division-consolidation patterns documented in Section 1.8; and substantive impacts on the substantive school-attendance and educational-trajectory of the children themselves through the broader social-determinants-of-educational-outcomes operating in poverty contexts.

AISH/ADAP/PDD (Section 1.4). The substantive engineered structural-poverty is most directly documented for the AISH/ADAP/PDD population in this Section 1.9. The substantive operational complications compound with the substantive Section 1.4 documented inadequacies including the elimination of caseworker continuity, the elimination of appeal rights, and the structural narrowing of eligibility documented for the ADAP transition. The substantive operational outcome is that the AISH/ADAP/PDD population faces the engineered structural-poverty plus the engineered substantive-disability-program-architecture inadequacies operating cumulatively.

Caregivers (Section 1.5). Caregivers of persons with disabilities operating below the Poverty Line face substantive operational complications including: substantive caregiver-employment-and-income complications produced by the substantive caregiving-time requirements operating against the substantive employment-and-income-pursuit obligations; substantive distance-from-respite-care complications that compound with the substantive geographic-distribution dimension documented in Section 1.8; substantive

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structural-housing complications that compound with the substantive accessible-housing-availability gaps; and substantive structural-isolation complications that compound with the substantive disability-community-advocacy-capacity constraints documented in this Section 1.9.

Triage and WCB (Section 1.6). The substantive Section 1.6 triage analysis documented the substantive structural distinction between the WCB-eligible-injured-worker population (with substantive caseworker continuity, substantive vocational-rehabilitation supports, substantive community reintegration supports, substantive earnings-replacement at substantive proportions of pre-injury earnings) and the AISH/ADAP-eligible disability population (with the substantive engineered structural-poverty documented in this Section 1.9). The substantive Section 1.9 finding is that the substantive Section 1.6 triage analysis operates with operational specificity at the income-support level: the WCB-eligible population is operationally protected from the engineered structural-poverty pattern through the substantive WCB earnings-replacement architecture; the AISH/ADAP-eligible population is operationally subjected to the engineered structural-poverty pattern. The substantive operational distinction between the two populations is not produced by the underlying disability profiles; it is produced by the substantive structural-policy choice to operate substantively distinct income-support architectures for substantively similar disability profiles.

Mental Health and Addiction (Section 1.7). The substantive disability-and-poverty intersection compounds with the substantive Section 1.7 mental-health-and-addiction dimension. The mental-health-disability AISH population (twenty-three thousand nine hundred forty Albertans, thirty-and-two-tenths percent of the September 2025 caseload) operates within the engineered structural-poverty pattern documented in Section 1.9. The substantive intersection with homelessness and incarceration documented in Section 1.7 operates substantively through the engineered structural-poverty: persons with mental-health-disability profiles operating below the Poverty Line face substantive structural risks of homelessness and incarceration that compound with the substantive Section 1.7 lifecycle dimension. The substantive opioid-and-stimulant toxicity crisis documented in Section 1.7 produces substantive disproportionate impact on the engineered-structural-poverty population including the documented finding that homeless individuals face approximately two-hundred-to-one-thousand-times higher risk of death from drug poisoning than housed people.

Rural, Remote, and Northern Alberta (Section 1.8). The substantive disability-and-poverty intersection operates with particular operational force in rural, remote, and northern Alberta as documented in Section 1.8. The substantive Section 1.8 rural-economy volatility, the substantive primary-resource-sector boom-and-bust cycles, the substantive geographic-distance-from-specialist-services dimension, and the substantive structural-housing-and-cost-of-living gaps in remote-and-northern communities all compound with the engineered structural-poverty documented in this Section 1.9. The substantive operational outcome is that rural, remote, and northern Albertans with disabilities operating below the Poverty Line face structurally-compounded operational conditions that the urban-context engineered-structural-poverty alone does not capture.

What Section 1.9 Establishes

All figures sourced from Government of Alberta open data, Statistics Canada, federal statute, UN treaty, and peer-reviewed research.

The substantive disability-and-poverty intersection is now documented at the depth required for the substantive case the blueprint develops. The substantive content establishes seven substantive findings.

First, the substantive AISH benefit-level for a single Albertan with a disability operates at approximately eighty percent of the Market Basket Measure Poverty Line in 2024, producing an annual gap of approximately five thousand six hundred seventy-four dollars below the Calgary MBM Poverty Line. The substantive Income Support Barriers to Full Employment population operates at substantively more inadequate levels (forty-three percent of the MBM); the Income Support employable single population operates at thirty-seven percent of the MBM. The substantive arithmetic is operationally specific and produced by specific provincial-government policy choices.

Second, the substantive nineteen-year time series documented through Maytree's *Welfare in Canada: Alberta* establishes that the AISH benefit-level has operated below the Poverty Line in eighteen of the nineteen years from 2006 to 2024, with 2013 the only year during which the benefit-level operationally met or exceeded the Poverty Line. The substantive operational finding is that the AISH-recipient population in 2024 operates at substantively the same poverty level relative to the Poverty Line as the AISH-recipient population in 2006, with the brief 2012-2017 improvement period reversed by subsequent policy choices.

Third, the substantive policy-choice sequence (2018 NDP Bill 26 indexation, 2019 UCP de-indexation, 2023 Alberta Escalator framework, 2026 ADAP transition, 2025 federal Canada Disability Benefit clawback) operates as a sustained structural-policy pattern. Alberta is the only province in Canada that operates a CDB clawback policy, operationally diverting the federal disability-poverty-reduction benefit from AISH recipients to provincial-government revenue.

Fourth, the compounding effects of the disability-and-poverty intersection produce structural barriers to food security, housing security, accommodation-cost coverage, disability-community advocacy capacity, legal and procedural representation, and substantive social and political participation. The compounding effects operate cumulatively rather than discretely, and the substantive operational outcome is that persons with disabilities in poverty experience structural exclusion from the substantive participation that the disability-policy architecture is rhetorically designed to support.

Fifth, the substantive disability-and-poverty intersection compounds with each lifecycle dimension Part One has documented (FSCD, K-12 including the engineered repudiation, AISH/ADAP/PDD, caregivers, WCB and triage, mental-health-and-addiction, rural-remote-and-northern). The substantive structural barriers documented in the prior sections compound with the substantive engineered structural-poverty documented in this section to produce operationally more substantial structural barriers than any individual lifecycle-dimension analysis alone identifies.

Sixth, the substantive Section 1.6 triage analysis is operationally completed by the Section 1.9 disability-and-poverty intersection. The substantive distinction between the WCB-eligible-injured-worker population (operationally protected from the engineered structural-poverty pattern) and the AISH/ADAP-eligible disability population (operationally subjected to the engineered structural-poverty pattern) is produced not by the underlying disability profiles but by the substantive structural-policy choice to operate substantively distinct income-support architectures for substantively similar disability profiles. The substantive analytical question Section 1.6 raised is operationally answered: the substantive

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distinction is engineered, sustained, and produces specific dollar-amount gaps that the documented data make operationally visible.

Seventh, the substantive case the blueprint develops in Parts Two and Three operates substantively against the engineered structural-poverty pattern through the substantive accessibility-standards architecture, the substantive structural-funding mechanisms developed in Part Three Section 3.7, and the substantive accountability-and-coordination layer developed in Part Three Section 3.8. The substantive specifications are calibrated to operate against the documented patterns at the operational level the documented Alberta record requires.

The substantive content of Section 1.9 establishes the structural backbone of the engineered Alberta disability-policy architecture. The engineered structural-poverty is not an unfortunate side effect of fiscal-policy decisions; it is the substantive operational mechanism through which the broader engineered patterns documented in Sections 1.3a (the K-12 engineered repudiation), 1.4 (the AISH-to-ADAP transition), 1.7 (the mental-health-and-addiction substantive policy direction), and 1.8 (the rural-remote-and-northern substantive geographic dimension) are sustained. Without engineered structural-poverty, the broader engineered patterns would lack the substantive operational mechanism through which they produce their documented operational outcomes; with engineered structural-poverty, the broader engineered patterns operate substantively against the population the disability-policy architecture is rhetorically designed to serve.

The next section turns to the substantive lifecycle dimension of aging, acquired disability, and end-of-life, completing the lifecycle frame established in Section 1.2 and addressing the substantive operational reality that the disability-policy architecture must engage across the complete substantive human-lifecycle trajectory.